

Types of Modern Slavery

Bonded Labour or Debt Bondage

This is where somebody is demanded to work in order to repay a loan; rather than pay it with money, they pay it with labour. However, many slaves never end up paying their loans back, leaving them stuck in slavery for the rest of their lives. This is because they are paid extremely low wages and they have money added to their loan for necessities like food and lodging. Additionally, they are often pressured into continuing to work for their master long after the debt has been paid. If a slave dies before they have repaid the loan, the debt can be passed on to their partner or children. This then becomes **descent-based slavery**. Migrant workers often become bonded labour to pay off those who smuggled them to the new country - they dare not break free for fear of being deported

Forced Labour

Forced labour is any labour that people are forced to do against their own will. Any kind of forced labour is slavery. There are now estimated to be around 25 million people in forced labour. They can be kept as prisoners and forced to perform domestic work. Migrants often have their passports taken from them by their workers, forcing them to stay in bondage.

Child Slavery

Worldwide, around one in four slaves are children. Children are used for physical labour, domestic slavery, fighting in armed conflict (e.g. the resistance army in Uganda) and commercial sexual abuse. There have been instances where orphan children have been adopted in order to be used as slaves.

Live-in Migrant and Domestic Workers

These are slaves which are confined to private homes. They maintain the household by cleaning, cooking and sometimes helping with childcare. Because they are in a private home, this makes them even more vulnerable to exploitation because they are isolated from the slavery protections that are offered in a regular workplace. This means that the worker can be easily pressured into working long hours and they can be threatened and assaulted more easily without detection. Employers can use the workers migrant status to pressure them into work, by threatening to hand them into the authorities.

Marital Slavery

Child marriage (under the age of 18 years old) is widely accepted in some cultures. However, this becomes slavery if:

1. Neither of the people have not agreed to the marriage – this is forced marriage.
2. If either of the people are being controlled or 'owned' by the other. For example, wives are often sold and brought.
3. If either of the people cannot leave the marriage, if they should want to.

Although boys can be affected, it is mainly girls who suffer slavery as a consequence of child marriage.

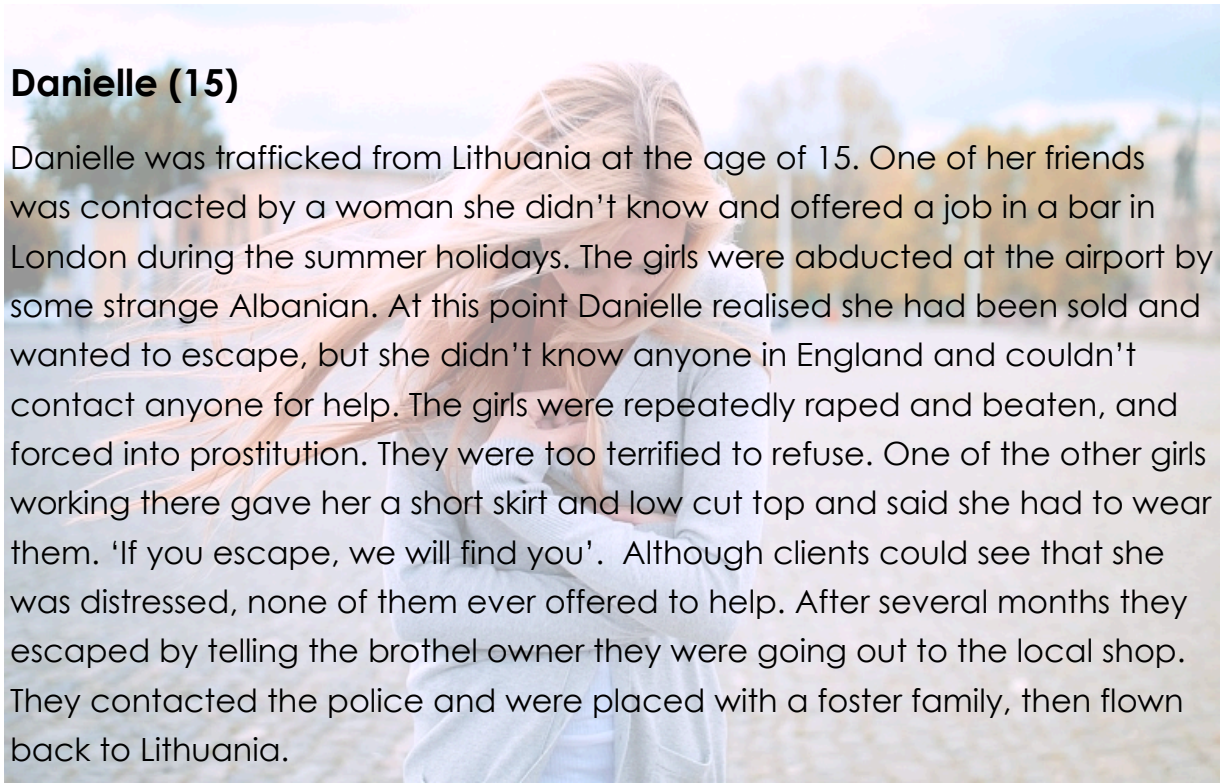
Modern Slavery Case Studies

Adina (16)

After her parents died, Adina found work helping on a market stall in Kampala, Uganda. One day the woman who ran the stall told her to go with two men. She said they were going to take her to live abroad, where she would be safe and could go to school. Adina was put on a plane to the UK, collected by a man at the airport, taken to a house and locked in a kitchen. For the next two years, Adina was forced to live in this one room. She had no idea where she was. Her 'job' was to clean and cook for her 'owner'. She was also physically abused. She finally managed to escape when one of the men fell asleep drunk and failed to lock the kitchen door. He woke and chased her, but she hid in a ditch before managing to flag down a car. The driver dropped her at Marylebone Police Station in London.

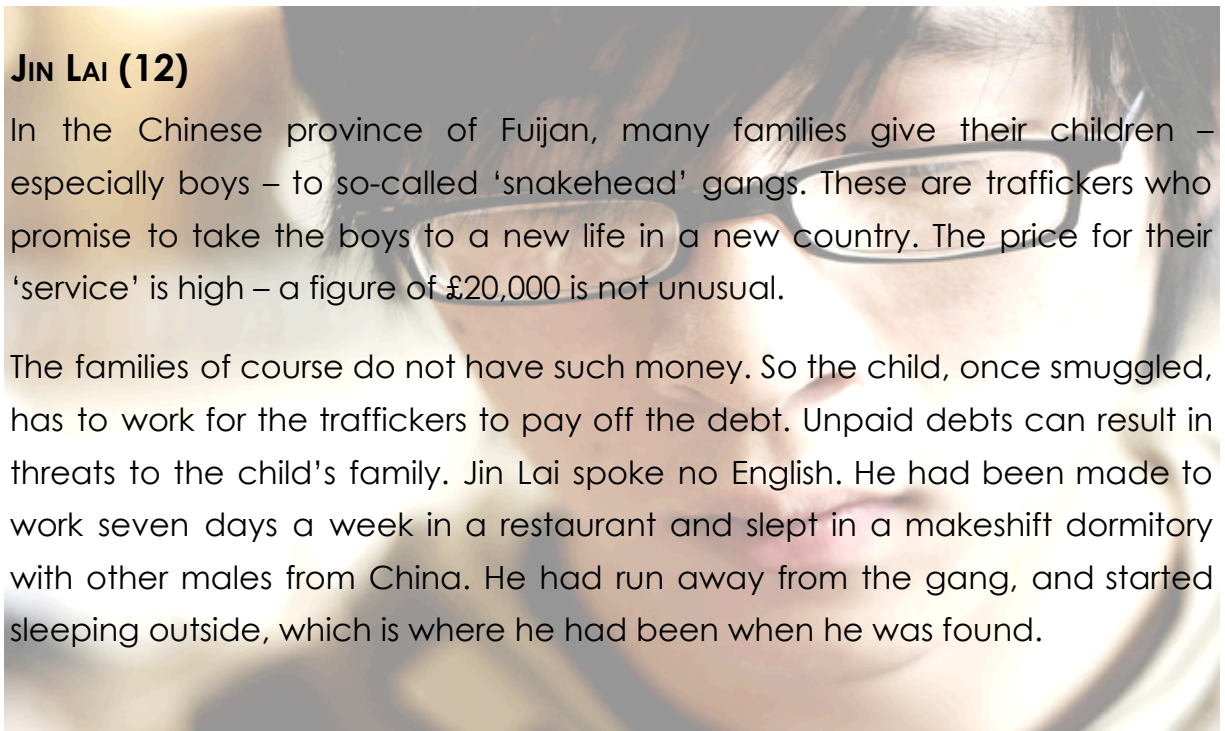
THEO (20)

Theo was one of 54 Greek Roma gipsies, including 10 women, rescued from a flower farm in Penzance, Cornwall. Local 'fixers' had promised them expenses, food, 'proper flats' and a choice to leave if they didn't like the work, for £34 a day. Instead they were housed in a barn with no heating or proper plumbing. As food, they shared cans of dog food. However, the 'gangmaster' refused to pay them, claiming they were in his debt for the costs of bringing them from Greece. When they tried to escape the gangmaster sent in heavies who beat them up with sticks and threatened at gunpoint to keep them working before they finally managed to escape.



Danielle (15)

Danielle was trafficked from Lithuania at the age of 15. One of her friends was contacted by a woman she didn't know and offered a job in a bar in London during the summer holidays. The girls were abducted at the airport by some strange Albanian. At this point Danielle realised she had been sold and wanted to escape, but she didn't know anyone in England and couldn't contact anyone for help. The girls were repeatedly raped and beaten, and forced into prostitution. They were too terrified to refuse. One of the other girls working there gave her a short skirt and low cut top and said she had to wear them. 'If you escape, we will find you'. Although clients could see that she was distressed, none of them ever offered to help. After several months they escaped by telling the brothel owner they were going out to the local shop. They contacted the police and were placed with a foster family, then flown back to Lithuania.



JIN LAI (12)

In the Chinese province of Fujian, many families give their children – especially boys – to so-called 'snakehead' gangs. These are traffickers who promise to take the boys to a new life in a new country. The price for their 'service' is high – a figure of £20,000 is not unusual.

The families of course do not have such money. So the child, once smuggled, has to work for the traffickers to pay off the debt. Unpaid debts can result in threats to the child's family. Jin Lai spoke no English. He had been made to work seven days a week in a restaurant and slept in a makeshift dormitory with other males from China. He had run away from the gang, and started sleeping outside, which is where he had been when he was found.